

OPEN SOURCE AUTOMATION TOOLS To Make Your HOME SMART



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Automating your home has become a rather complex task with the ever expanding number of devices available to automatically protect and monitor your home. There are many open source devices to control window shutters, doors, fans, lights, air-conditioners, microwave ovens, etc in the market. On one hand, you may want to protect your home from theft, fire or other threats, while on the other, you may be interested in reducing your energy usage, for which there are countless devices available. Home automation can include scheduling and automatic operation of lighting, heating, air-conditioning, window shutters, security systems and more.

The many possibilities in home automation enable you to build wireless networks, automate all consumer electronic devices at home, monitor pets when you are away, set up an answering system, create a weather station and more. All of this involves integrating many different home automation technologies into one.

A home automation system works on its own protocols, which are specific to the company that developed the system. Software companies may favour such an approach as it ties customers to only their products. It is therefore important to evaluate a home automation system to ensure that it is built on open protocols. Such open solutions are released under an open source licence.

Home automation may also allow vital home functions to be controlled remotely from anywhere in the world, using any device with a browser that has an Internet connection.

A smart home is a wonderful thing. It learns your habits, watches out for intruders and even sends you alerts when things do not go according to plan. And it communicates with you remotely.

Trustworthy and powerful communication protocols like Z-wave or Zigbee still work with open source systems. Hubs that work with open source smart home software are competitively priced, and are

In a smart home, controlled objects are typically connected to a hub, which may be a wall-mounted unit, a tablet or even a smartphone. This article lists nine open source home automation tools you can choose from to make your home smart

